The Patient Enquiry Playbook

A practical website and search guide for private clinics in Ireland

Start with a clearer path

Patients need to understand your care, trust your team and know what to do next. This guide helps you review that path, from a treatment search to an enquiry.

What you will work on

Choose a treatment and audience. Improve one treatment page. Make contact easier. Measure useful enquiries. Use a focused 30-day action plan.

Who this is for

Owners and managers of dental, aesthetic, hair restoration and private practices. Use the examples as planning prompts and adapt them to your services and resources.

A useful starting point

Open your website on a phone. Can a new visitor identify the treatment, the clinician and the next step without guessing? Write down the first obstacle you notice.

01 / Choose a focused starting point

One treatment. One audience. One useful next step.

Name the treatment

Start with a service you can explain clearly and have capacity to deliver. Avoid making your first project a rewrite of every page. Record the treatment, responsible clinician and desired enquiry type.

Describe the patient question

List the questions your reception team hears before a consultation: suitability, appointment process, location, likely visits and how pricing is explained. Use these questions to plan the page.

Choose a market deliberately

For an international audience, consider language, travel, follow-up arrangements and whether the clinic can support the full patient journey. Do not target a country simply because search volume looks attractive.

Worksheet

Our first treatment: _____
Our intended audience: _____
Their main unanswered question: _____
The next step we want them to take: _____

02 / Build a page patients can use

Make the offer, evidence and next step easy to find.

Lead with the patient need

Write a heading that explains what the page helps the visitor understand. Add a short introduction describing the service, location and consultation process. Avoid guaranteed outcomes or unsupported superlatives.

Show real evidence

Use accurate clinician biographies, actual clinic photographs and clear explanations of your process. Only publish credentials, testimonials and outcome examples that you can substantiate and have permission to use.

Answer before asking

Explain what happens at the first appointment, how suitability is assessed, what information is available about fees and how follow-up works. Have the clinical team review treatment information.

Make contact predictable

Use a specific button such as Request a consultation. Explain what happens after the enquiry and give a realistic response window your team can meet. Test the whole journey on a phone.

03 / Help the right people find you

Match each page to a real question and a real service.

Organise by treatment

Give important services their own useful pages, with descriptive titles and clear internal links. Use the words patients use, while keeping clinical descriptions accurate. Avoid near-identical pages created only to repeat town names.

Keep local details consistent

Check your clinic name, location, contact details and opening hours wherever you publish them. Make directions and accessibility information easy to locate. Link relevant service pages from your main navigation.

Plan international pages carefully

Publish translations that your team can maintain and review. Explain practical travel and follow-up arrangements where relevant. Ask your developer to check language URLs, canonical tags and hreflang when multiple versions exist.

Check the basics

Confirm that key pages load, work on mobile and can be discovered by search engines. Review search impressions and clicks over time. Search visibility is an input to the enquiry journey, not a promise of appointments.

04 / Turn interest into a conversation

Reduce uncertainty at the moment someone contacts you.

Ask only what you need

Start with the minimum information your team needs to route an enquiry. Explain why any required field is needed. Avoid requesting sensitive clinical details in a general marketing form or initial messaging exchange.

Give a helpful first reply

Example: Thank you for contacting our clinic. Which service would you like to discuss? Our team can explain the consultation process and help you arrange the next step. Adapt the reply to your staffing and services.

Track the journey

Record aggregate counts for visits, enquiries, suitable enquiries and booked consultations. Decide what suitable means before reporting. Keep sensitive patient information out of marketing analytics.

Find the actual bottleneck

Few visits may call for better visibility. Visits without enquiries may point to unclear information or a difficult contact flow. Enquiries without consultations may point to response time, fit or appointment availability. Investigate before changing everything.

05 / Your 30-day action plan

A small, measurable improvement each week.

Week 1 / Review

Choose one treatment page. Record your baseline enquiries and the current contact journey. Ask reception for the three most common unanswered questions. Identify the owner of each improvement.

Week 2 / Clarify

Rewrite the introduction and next-step button. Add missing practical information and verified clinician details. Review treatment copy with the clinical team.

Week 3 / Test

Test the page and contact flow on mobile. Check links, confirmations and team routing. Review language and search settings with your developer. Fix the most consequential obstacles first.

Week 4 / Learn

Compare enquiries and their suitability with your baseline. Small samples can mislead, so use patient questions and team feedback alongside the numbers. Choose the next improvement based on what you learned.

Where am I losing visitors?

Already have a website and wondering, "Where am I losing visitors?" Get in touch with me, and let's find out together.

Request my free review on WhatsApp